



A section of the Just Dial office at Chennai

Leading Search Engine Dials Open Source for a Growth Call!

Open source technology enabled Just Dial, India's leading local search engine, to grow at a much faster rate and achieve a lot more than it planned for.

Every business that signs on to adopt technology hopes it will be a fruitful partnership. Just Dial, India's leading local search engine, began its relationship with open source technology about three and a half years ago, and has never looked back. It's grown by leaps and bounds, and now caters to over 25 million unique users across 240 cities in India. It employs over 4,000 people and has more than 125,000 SME advertisers today. And behind this successful business is none other than the 'open' hand!

"Open source technology enabled us not only to dream big but live the big dream. It allowed us to scale up in a seamless manner, helping us grow without having to worry much about the procuring part of open source. Second, because of the open architecture, we were able to introduce best practices from various fields and add value to our search process. We used

open source tools from sociology, politics, economics, etc, modifying them as per our requirements to get the most out of these tools. In a nutshell, this approach allowed us to extricate more information and give refined search results to our end users," says Sandipan Chattopadhyay, CTO, Just Dial.

The first spark

In 2007, Just Dial went in for a Web-based server system based on an open architecture. The ambitious project to make a client-facing website provide more than the telephonic service it traditionally offered its customers, triggered Just Dial's move towards open source technology. The firm had decided to launch two websites – one client-facing and another for internal use. Back then, Just Dial had a DOS-based system built in FoxPro. The company operated out of eight regional offices that were faced with everyday